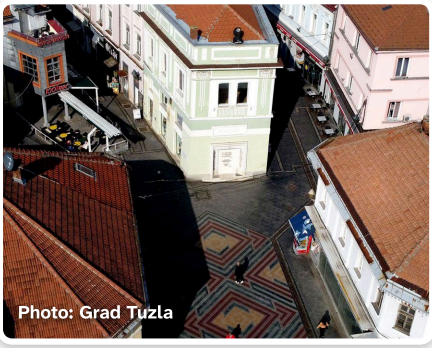
Introduction to Tuzla:
THE TOWN OF SALT

TOP PLACES TO VISIT

Freedom Square (Trg slobode)

- About 8,000 m², called the largest square in Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- In the middle is a large fountain shaped like a salt-boiling dish.
- Around it stand the 16th-century Bazaar Mosque, the Ruždija (1883), the Čaršijska česma drinking fountain (1888) and the Baroque building (1900).
- The first Neolithic finds came up here in 1903, when it was called Appel Platz.


Photo: Grad Tuzla


Photo: Grad Tuzla

Salt Square (Solni trg)

- An open-air salt museum in the old town.
- It has an Ottoman salt well, a fountain given by Ravenna in the shape of a Neolithic salt dish, and a replica of how salt was boiled.
- A salt well here was dug or modernised in 1476, and up to 80 pans boiled brine on this spot.

The Korzo, and “at Meša and Ismet”

- The Korzo is Turali Bey's Street, from the Kapija to the statues of Meša and Ismet.
- The statues are of the writer Meša Selimović and the painter Ismet Mujezinović, both from Tuzla.
- They are the city's meeting point: “kod Meše i Ismeta” is all you need to say.
- The Tourist Information Center is beside the Korzo, at Turalibegova 5.



Photo: Grad Tuzla

The Kapija

- At one end of the Korzo. On 25 May 1995 a shell hit the Kapija, the centre of the city's nightlife, and killed 71 people, most of them young.
- A memorial carries every name. Pass it quietly.

Introduction to Tuzla:
SALT, THE GOAT AND THE PAST

A CITY ON A GRAIN OF SALT

The name

- Tuzla comes from the Turkish *tuz*, salt.
- Its older names are about salt too: Ad Salinas in Latin, Soli in South Slavic.
- Locals call it “the city on a grain of salt”: rock salt and salt water left by the Pannonian Sea.


Photo: Grad Tuzla


Photo: Grad Tuzla

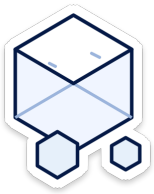
Older than Rome

- Neolithic pile dwellings stood in what is now the centre.
- Two reconstructed salt-boiling pots date to about 5,000 and 3,500 BC.
- An archaeological park of pile dwellings opened at the lakes in summer 2006.
- Louis XIV bought Tuzla salt in the 17th century.

The goat

- Under Austro-Hungarian rule, goats were banned to protect the forests.
- One man in Mosnik kept his goat, and the saying was born: “Cijela Tuzla jednu kozu muzla”, all of Tuzla milked one goat.
- In GoatConf's telling, that one goat fed the whole town with milk and cheese.
- The tourist board makes Tuzla's goat a photo stop, and the city has a goat statue.





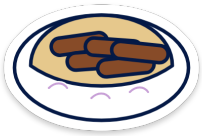
Museums and the park

- The Museum of Eastern Bosnia holds about 30,000 objects, some over 7,000 years old.
- The International Portrait Gallery (1964) holds more than 5,000 works.
- The Pannonica exhibition shows tuzlaite, a mineral found only in Tuzla's salt.
- The City Park has granite paths, free Wi-Fi and a footbridge to the salt lakes.

Introduction to Tuzla:
FOOD AND COFFEE

WHAT TO EAT

Ćevapi



- Small rolls of minced meat with onion, served in lepinja or somun with chopped onion, often with kajmak or yoghurt.
- Tuzla's own: mutton, beef and lamb, in a lepinja first dipped in poljev, a beef-bone broth.
- About 7 to 10 KM for five, 12 to 15 KM for ten (Tuzla menus, October 2026).



Pita

- Burek, zeljanica, sirnica and krompiruša: thin pastry with meat, greens, cheese or potato.
- About 3 to 5.5 KM for 250 g (menus, October 2026).

Cooked dishes

- Sarma (stuffed rolls) and punjene paprike (stuffed peppers): 6 to 14 KM on Tuzla menus.
- Grah, a bean stew: 6 to 13 KM. Begova čorba, the bey's soup: 6 to 9 KM.
- Meat-free dishes are on the menus at Pizza Bar, Pekara Hukić, Mozaik, Caffe Pizzeria Old School Pub and Zmaj od Bosne.

Sweets, coffee and beer



- Tufahija (3.5 to 5 KM) and hurmašice (1.7 to 4 KM).
- A cappuccino is about 3.25 KM (about 1.66 €).
- Pivara Tuzla has brewed since 1884, with water piped from Konjuh. Its own pub, Pivnica Taverna, pours unfiltered beer at Maršala Tita 163.
- Sloboda caffe bar sits on Salt Square, at Solni trg 10.
- The central market has sold fruit, vegetables and local products since 1952.

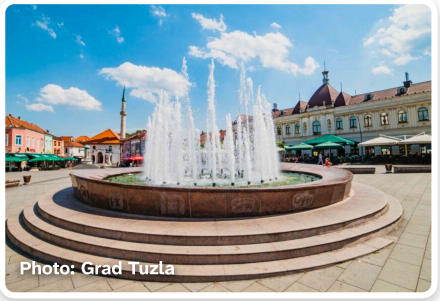
Prices were read on menus in October 2026 and will change. 1 € is 1.95583 KM, a fixed rate.

Introduction to Tuzla:
GETTING AROUND

AROUND IPI ACADEMY

Where GoatConf is

- The talks are in English, at IPI Academy, Kulina bana 2, in the centre of Tuzla.
- Coffee and lunch are in the cafés on Freedom Square, under five minutes' walk away.

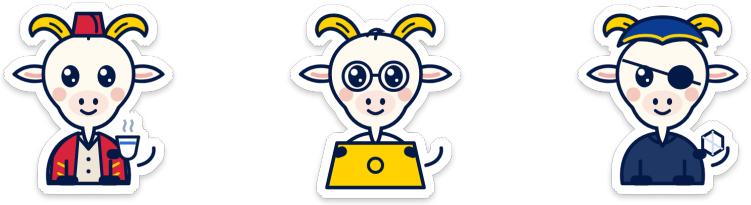

Photo: Grad Tuzla

Getting about

- A tourist train runs from Freedom Square to the salt lakes.
- Nextbike bike share: 20 KM a year to register, the first 30 minutes free, then 1.5 KM an hour.
- Free city Wi-Fi, “Tuzla Wireless City”, covers the old town in 30-minute sessions.
- A city bus ticket is 2.50 KM.
- Taxis start at 3 KM.
- From the airport, a private transfer is about 12 minutes.

Good to know

- Money: the convertible mark (KM). 1 € is 1.95583 KM.
- The airport has ATMs and an exchange office.
- Foreigners register with the police within 72 hours. Hotels usually do it for you.
- EHIC and GHIC cards do not cover Bosnia and Herzegovina: bring travel insurance.
- June is warm and the wettest month: highs about 26 °C, about 11 rain days.
- Emergency: ambulance 124, fire 123, police 122.
- Maps and event news: Tourist Information Center, Turalibegova 5.

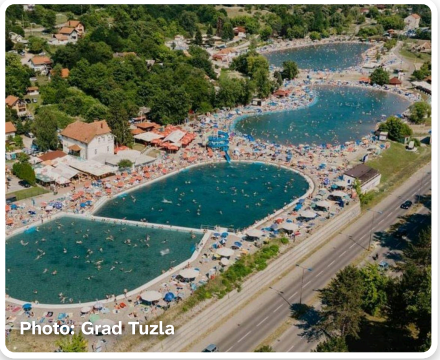


Introduction to Tuzla:
IN AND AROUND TUZLA

THINGS TO DO

The Pannonian salt lakes (Panonika)

- Three salt-water lakes in the city centre, filled from underground salt wells.
- They opened in 2003, 2008 and 2012, with salt waterfalls, an archaeological park and water slides.
- They won the UNWTO Ulysses award in 2012.
- The season opens on 1 June, so they are open during GoatConf.
- In 2026 an adult ticket was 7 KM on weekdays and 9 KM at weekends.


Photo: Grad Tuzla

Slana banja park

- Next to the lakes: paths, sports courts, cafés, views, war memorials and the Peace Flame House.

Konjuh mountain

- Averages 1,000 m and peaks at 1,328 m, with conifer and beech forest.
- Stećak necropolises and the old caravan road that carried Tuzla's salt.
- Hike with a local guide: landmines remain in rural areas, so stay on roads and paths.

Srebrenik Fortress

- First recorded in 1333, a national monument since 2004.
- It stands on a rock about 5 km from Srebrenik's centre, entered by a small bridge.

Gradačac

- A fort with 18 m walls and a 22 m tower, built by Husein-kapetan Gradaščević, the “Dragon of Bosnia”.
- A spa on thermal springs since 1882, and the lakes Hazna and Vidara.

Husino

- The village of the 1920 miners' rebellion, with Ivan Sabolić's monument and the victims' steles in its park.